THE QUIET VALE

Seasons of Settlement



RULEBOOK

A game of stewardship and renewal

1 to 5 players · 45 to 150 minutes · Cooperative

The Quiet Vale

> *War's banners have long since fallen silent. Old military roads now carry traders, settlers and wandering folk looking for somewhere safe to begin again. Across three Seasons you will gather resources, grow one shared settlement, welcome Arrivals and meet the Burdens of a fractured world.*
>
> *The Quiet Vale is a game of stewardship: build carefully, support your neighbours and leave the Vale stronger than you found it.*

The aim of the game

Build Population and earn Renown together over 12 rounds. Complete Steward Objectives, Arrivals and the Quest Card, resolve Burdens and protect the settlement from Strain. After Round 12, work out one shared final score. There is no separate winning threshold and no individual winner. Record the score, and file the Quest Card in the Steward's Ledger if you completed it.

YOUR SHARED SCORE Population and Renown, plus Steward Objective, Quest Card and Golden bonuses, minus 10 for each active Burden, each failed Arrival and each Strain on the map.



A settlement at the end of a game: 19 Tiles, a few Strain still to clear and one Supported Cottage.

Using this rulebook

New to the Vale?

Read pages 4 to 11 in order: the shortest route into the game, what is in the box, setup, seeding, the round and a guided first round. Then start playing, and look up the rest when it comes up.

Coming back?

The Quick reference on page 32 and Questions at the table on page 33 cover what most often needs checking.

Leave Golden content in the box for your first game. Rings, numbers and arrows drawn over a picture are there to explain it; they are not on the board.

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WHEN RULES CONFLICT Text on a specific card or Tile overrides a general rule, but only for the situation it names. Otherwise follow this rulebook, and finish every mandatory effect before play continues.

The shortest route into the Vale

Your group shares one settlement and one final score. Across three Seasons you decide where to build, what to produce and when to face the Vale's Encounters. There is no winning threshold: you simply try to leave the Vale as strong as you can.

One game, three Seasons, twelve rounds

I
Foundations
Rounds 1 to 4
Then: Season transition

II
Growth
Rounds 5 to 8
Then: Season transition

III
Maturity
Rounds 9 to 12
Then: Final scoring

Before each Season, every player secretly seeds 3 Encounter Cards from their hand into the deck: one on top, one in the middle and one at the bottom.

Every round

1 Encounters
Reveal one Encounter Card per player and resolve what they say.

2 Player turns
Choose the order. Each player takes one turn of up to 4 Actions: Place, Upgrade, Activate or Interact.

3 End of the round
Arrivals lose a timer, short effects end, and the Round marker moves on.

Keep three ideas in view

Reach
You can only act where your meeple can reach through the settlement. Every Place, Upgrade and Activate moves it.

The Warehouse
All resources are shared. Production fills the Warehouse; every cost comes out of it.

Strain
Burdens and failed Arrivals put Strain on Tiles. At 3 Strain a Tile stops working, spreads Strain and every Strain costs points.

SCORE TOGETHER Population and Renown from your Tiles, plus Steward Objectives and the Quest Card, minus 10 for each active Burden, failed Arrival and Strain on the map.

The next pages show what is in the box and how to set up. Pages 10 and 11 then play a first round with you.

What is in the box

Everything below appears in the setup picture on page 6; the numbers in circles match it.

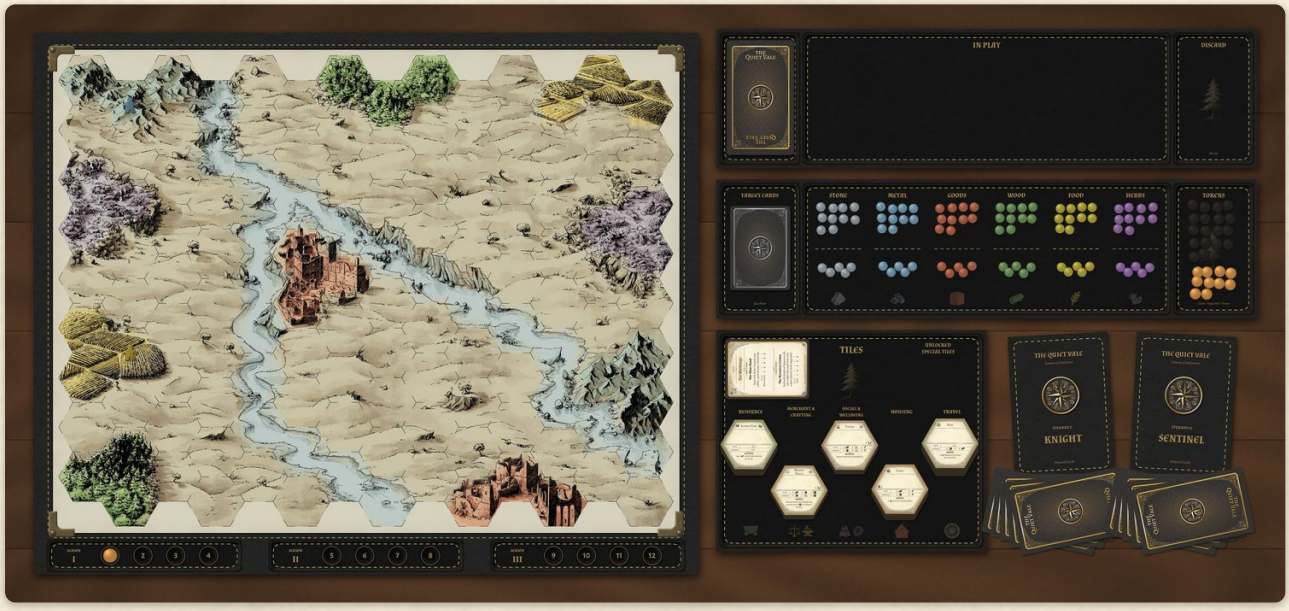
COMPONENT	IN THE BOX	PICTURE
Map board	The Vale on a flat-top hex grid, with the round tracker along its foot: three Season trays of four rounds.	1
Encounter board	Wells for the Encounter deck and the discard pile, and the In play area between them.	4
Logistics board	The Target deck well, the six-resource Warehouse and the token tray.	5 6 7
Tiles board	The Quest Card, unlocked Special Tiles and the Core Tile supply in five bays.	8 9
Core Tiles	70 double-sided Tiles across 21 types, each with a basic side and an upgraded side, plus 14 Travel extension hexes. A Street covers 2 hexes in a line and a Track 3; the extensions complete them.	9
Special Tiles	28 hexes across 25 designs, each with a numbered back that matches an Arrival's reward. Stables uses two separate hexes.	
Golden Tiles	5 Tiles with a plain Golden back, unlocked through the Steward's Ledger.	
Encounter Cards	90 tarot-size cards: 30 Boons, 30 Burdens, 25 Arrivals and 5 Golden Boons (page 18).	4 11
Quest Cards	21 poker-size cards with gold backs (page 29).	8
Target Cards	30 poker-size cards with silver backs (page 23).	5
Stewards	6 Steward Guides and 6 matching wooden Steward meeples (page 26).	2 10
Resources	90 wooden pieces in six colours: 15 each of Wood, Stone, Metal, Food, Herbs and Goods.	6
Tokens	Black wooden Strain tokens, and bronze tokens for Supported, Arrival timers and the Round marker.	3 7

BEFORE YOUR FIRST GAME Leave the Golden Tiles and Golden Boons in the box. They enter play only once the Steward's Ledger unlocks them (page 29).

Setting up a two-player game



1. The map board, with the round tracker along its foot.
2. Each Steward meeple on its Starting Terrain: here the Knight on Arable Land and the Sentinel on Mountains.
3. The Round marker in the Round 1 socket.
4. The Encounter deck, face down.
5. The Target deck, shuffled once and face down.
6. The Warehouse: 10 of every resource for two players, spare pieces below the stitch.
7. Strain and bronze tokens.
8. This game's Quest Card.
9. The Core Tile supply, basic side up, by category.
10. Each player's Steward Guide.
11. Each player's hidden hand of 9 Encounter Cards.



Alternative layout. The Encounter board, the Logistics board and the Tiles board lie flat in a column to the right of the map.

Setup step by step

Prepare the shared area

2.1 Lay out the map board. Stand the Encounter board on end along its left side and the Logistics board on end along its right side, both with their lettering facing the map, and put the Tiles board beyond the Logistics board. For the alternative layout, lay the three boards flat in a column to the right of the map instead (page 6).

2.2 Sort the Core Tiles into the Tiles board's five bays with every basic side face up. The upgraded side is the back of the same Tile, so there is no separate upgraded supply. Keep the Travel extension hexes with the Travel Tiles.

2.3 Arrange the Special Tiles by their numbered backs, ready to match to Arrival rewards.

2.4 Put the Round marker in the Round 1 socket.

2.5 Shuffle the 30 Target Cards once and put the deck face down in its well. There is no discard pile and you never reshuffle it.

2.6 Draw the top card of the Quest deck onto the Tiles board. Before your group's very first game, shuffle the 21 Quest Cards to make the Quest deck; after that, keep its order from game to game (page 29).

Choose Stewards

Each player chooses a different Steward and takes its Steward Guide and meeple. Read each Steward's Starting Terrain, Power and Objective aloud. For 1 player, choose 1 Steward and use the 1-player values wherever they are shown. For 5 players, return the sixth Steward to the box.

Fill the Warehouse

PLAYERS	1	2	3	4	5
Each resource	15	10	5	0	0

The Warehouse holds at most 15 of each resource unless an effect changes the limit. All resources are shared. Resources never go below zero: losing a resource you do not have has no effect.

Build the Encounter material

2.7 Sort the standard Encounter Cards by type and shuffle each type. For each player, take 4 Boons, 4 Burdens and 4 Arrivals: a pool of 12 cards per player. For 5 players, take 20 of each type, 60 cards in all.

2.8 Shuffle the pool and deal 9 hidden cards to each player.

2.9 Put the remaining 3 cards per player face down in the Encounter well as the starting deck. For 5 players that is the last 15 cards.

2.10 Return every unselected standard card to the box as the reserve. Keep it apart and do not look through it unless an effect tells you to.

HIDDEN HANDS Talk freely about strategy, timing and broad plans, but do not name hidden cards or quote their exact effects.

Place the Steward meeples

Each player puts their meeple on an empty hex of their Steward's Starting Terrain. This places no Tile and costs nothing. Two meeples cannot share a hex.

FIRST PLACEMENT On your first turn, your first Action must place any legal Tile on the hex under your meeple. It need not be a Resource Tile and need not connect to another Tile.

Then seed the Encounter deck for Season I (page 8) and begin Round 1.

Seeding the Encounter deck

A game lasts 12 rounds across three Seasons of four rounds: Foundations (Rounds 1 to 4), Growth (Rounds 5 to 8) and Maturity (Rounds 9 to 12). Before each Season, every player commits 3 cards from their hand and chooses where each enters the Encounter deck.

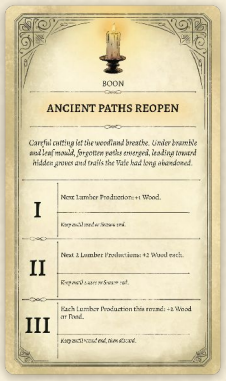
Choose the cards, then the positions

3.1 Choose 3 cards from your hidden hand. In Seasons I and II, keep the others in your hand for a later Season.

3.2 Seed one chosen card on top of the Encounter deck.

3.3 Push one into the middle, without counting the deck.

3.4 Seed the last one at the bottom.



Top
Comes up soonest.



Middle
Somewhere in the Season.



Bottom
Most likely to cross into the next Season.



The Encounter deck
Seeded cards go in face down; nobody sees where the others went.

Seed before Rounds 1, 5 and 9. Cards already in the deck stay where they are. In a normal game, 2 standard cards per player remain in the deck after Season I and 1 per player after Season II, and every remaining standard card is revealed in Season III. A low card can therefore cross into the next Season and use that Season's row. Nobody may count, inspect, reorder or reveal the deck unless an effect allows it.

TWO TIMING DECISIONS First choose which 3 cards enter the deck this Season; this is your clearest control over the Season row. Then choose top, middle and bottom. Top usually comes up sooner, while bottom is the most likely to cross into the next Season. Position guides timing; it never fixes an exact round.

CARD	BRING IT FORWARD	HOLD IT BACK OR SEED IT LOWER
Boon	Speed up a plan, or give a kept effect more time before the Season ends.	Use a stronger later-Season row, or wait until its targets exist.
Burden	Reveal its weaker current-Season row while resolving it is cheaper and more time remains before it reapplies.	Gain time to prepare, at the risk of a stronger row, a higher cost and less time to respond.
Arrival	Unlock its Special Tile with more of the game left to use it. It still starts with 3 timers.	Wait until its Requirements are easier to meet, but leave less time to use the Tile.

How a round works

PHASE	WHAT HAPPENS
1. Reveal Encounters	Reveal cards until the number of standard Encounter Cards revealed equals the player count. Resolve every mandatory effect before turns begin. Put Arrivals and kept Boons and Burdens in the In play area.
2. Player turns	The group chooses the order. Each player then takes exactly one turn of up to 4 Actions.
3. End of the round	Remove 1 timer from every active Arrival and resolve any that run out. Discard effects whose time is up, refresh effects used this round, then move the Round marker on.



The Encounter board during Round 2 of a two-player game.

1. The Encounter deck.
2. An Arrival with its 3 bronze timers.
3. An active Burden.
4. A Boon kept face up until it is used.

PENDING EFFECTS A pending effect is any mandatory choice, payment, placement, Strain, chain or other instruction already started but not finished. Finish it before turns begin or before moving to the next step.

GOLDEN CONTENT Golden Tiles and Golden Boons stay in the box until the Steward's Ledger unlocks them. If your group uses them, see page 30.

Your first round

Follow two players through Round 1, using the setup on page 6: the Knight on Arable Land and the Sentinel on Mountains, with 10 of every resource in the Warehouse.

Before the round

Each player chooses 3 cards from their hand and seeds them into the Encounter deck: one on top, one in the middle and one at the bottom. The other 6 stay in hand for Seasons II and III.

1. Reveal Encounters

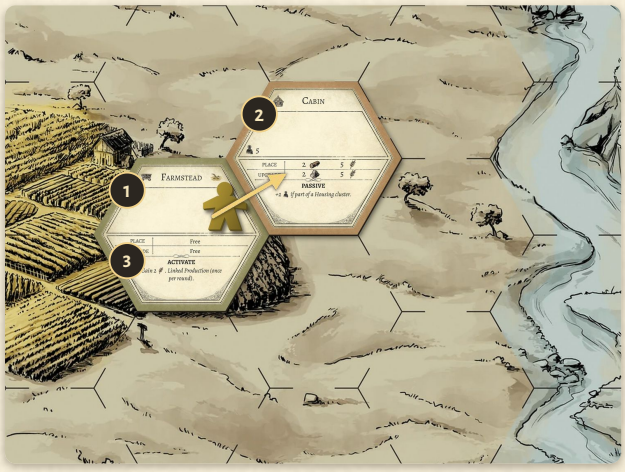
With two players, reveal 2 cards. They are *Quiet Quest*, an Arrival, and *Old Wounds Reopen*, a Burden.

Quiet Quest goes in play with a bronze timer in each of its 3 circles. Paying 4 Goods and 2 Herbs will unlock Special Tile 1.

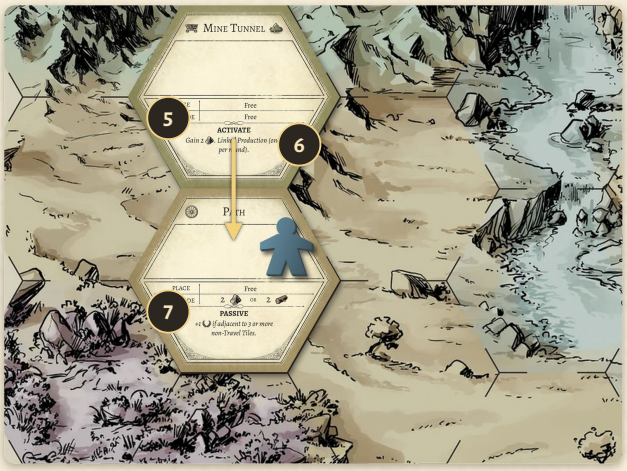
Old Wounds Reopen applies its Season I row: choose 1 Social or Wellbeing Tile, then pay 2 Herbs or put 1 Strain on it. There is no such Tile yet, so nothing happens, but the Burden stays active. Left alone it would apply again in Season II and cost 10 points at the end.

2. Player turns

The players agree that the Knight goes first. Their turns are on the next page; this is the map once both have played.



The Knight on Arable Land: Actions 1 to 3.



The Sentinel on the Mountains: Actions 5 to 7.

Your first round, continued

The Knight's turn

1. **Place** a Farmstead on the hex under the meeple. This is the first placement, so it must go there. A Farmstead costs nothing.
2. **Place** a Cabin beside it, paying 2 Wood and 5 Food. The meeple moves onto the Cabin.
3. **Activate** the Farmstead: it is reachable from the Cabin and produces 2 Food. The meeple moves back onto it.
4. **Interact** to resolve *Old Wounds Reopen*: pay 2 Herbs and discard it. Interact does not move the meeple.

The Knight's Power is still unused. It can be used once later this Season.

The Sentinel's turn

5. **Place** a Mine Tunnel on the Mountains hex under the meeple: the first placement. It costs nothing.
6. **Activate** the Mine Tunnel: it produces 2 Stone.
7. **Place** a Path beside it, for nothing. The meeple moves onto the Path, ready to build outward next round.
8. **Interact** to complete *Quiet Quest*: pay 4 Goods and 2 Herbs, remove its timers and discard it. Set Special Tile 1, the Adventurers' Guild, on the Tiles board to place later.

The Warehouse through the round

	WOOD	STONE	METAL	FOOD	HERBS	GOODS
Start	10	10	10	10	10	10
After the Knight	8	10	10	7	8	10
After the Sentinel	8	12	10	7	6	6

3. End of the round

No Arrival is still active, so no timers come off. The Farmstead and Mine Tunnel refresh for next round, and the Round marker moves to Round 2. The group has used every Action, cleared the Burden and unlocked its first Special Tile.

WHAT TO TRY NEXT ROUND Upgrade a Tile, link two copies of the same Resource Tile for Linked Production (page 13), or build towards the Quest Card's easier half.

The four Actions

On your turn, take up to 4 Actions. You may repeat an Action as often as each use is legal. Unused Actions are lost when your turn ends.

Place
Put an available Tile on a legal, reachable empty hex and pay its cost.

Upgrade
Pay the upgraded cost and flip a reachable basic Core Tile.

Activate
Use a reachable, non-Overstrained Tile's Activated Effect, such as Production.

Interact
Complete an active Arrival, or resolve an active Burden.

Place a Tile

5.1 Choose an available Tile.

5.2 Choose an empty, reachable hex.

5.3 Check terrain, adjacency and the Tile's printed placement rule.

5.4 Pay its cost from the Warehouse. An unlocked Special Tile costs nothing to place.

5.5 Place the Tile, resolve any placement effect and move your meeple onto it.

Do not place a Tile on River/Water unless its own rule allows or requires it, as the Bridge's does.

Upgrade a Tile

Choose a reachable, placed basic Core Tile that is not Overstrained. Pay the cost printed for its upgraded side and flip the same Tile in place. Its upgraded name, effect and scores now apply. Upgraded, Special, Golden and Overstrained Tiles cannot be upgraded.

5.6 Choose a reachable basic Core Tile that is not Overstrained.

5.7 Spend 1 Action and pay the upgrade cost.

5.8 Flip the Tile, resolve any effect the upgrade creates and move your meeple onto it.

Activate a Tile

Spend 1 Action to use a reachable, non-Overstrained Tile's Activated Effect, and pay any cost printed with it. A Tile may be activated more than once when each use is legal. Passive effects never need the Activate Action. If it is Production, apply Linked Production when it is allowed (page 13). Then move your meeple onto the Tile.

Interact with an Encounter

Arrival. Choose an active Arrival, meet and pay its Requirements and spend 1 Action. Remove its timers, discard it, and set the matching Special Tile on the Tiles board (page 17).

Burden. Choose an active Burden, spend 1 Action and carry out its current-Season resolution, including any payment. Discard it. Strain it has already placed stays.

If another effect resolves a Burden, follow that effect's own cost and timing instead. Interact does not move your meeple.

Your meeple marks where you reach from

Place, Upgrade and Activate move your meeple onto the Tile you chose, and your next reach is measured from there. Interact does not move it.

EXAMPLE On page 11 the Knight places a Farmstead, places a Cabin (the meeple moves to it), then activates the Farmstead (the meeple moves back). Resolving the Burden with Interact leaves the meeple where it is.

FREE EFFECTS Face-up Boons and Steward Powers cost no Action unless their text says otherwise. A benefit that costs 0 Actions saves only the Action: still pay the resource cost unless the effect also changes it.

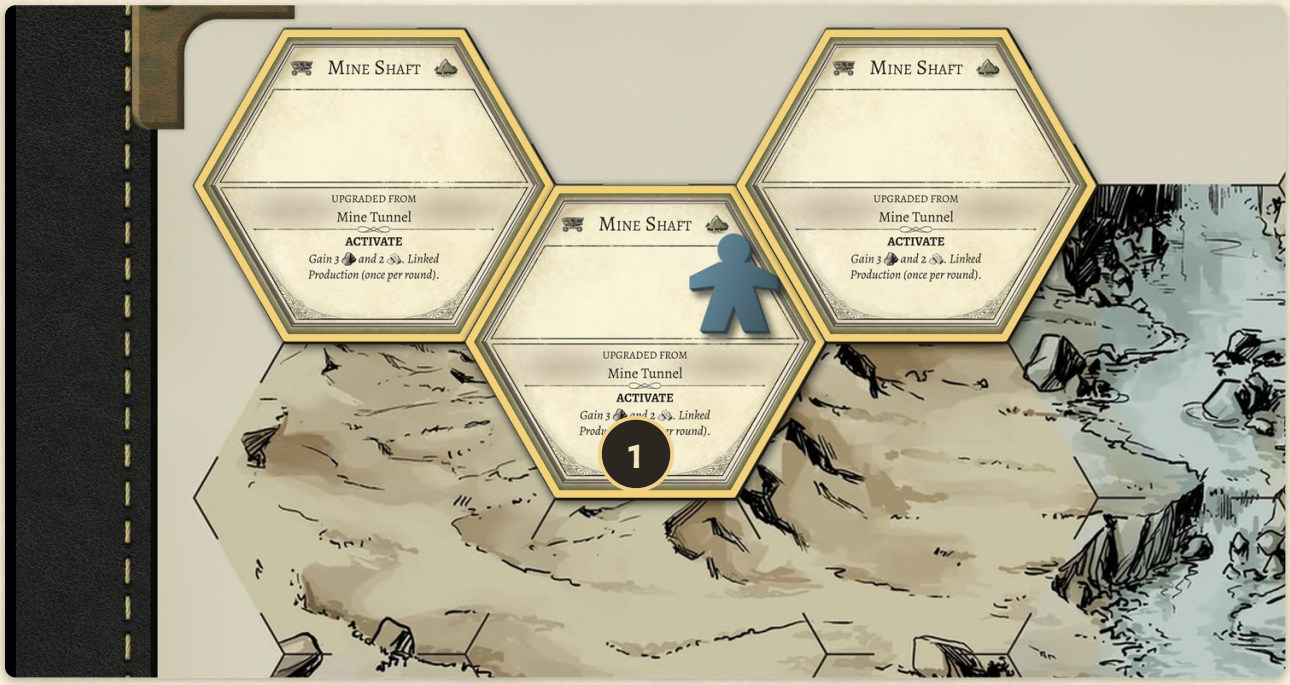
Production

Production is an Activated Effect on Resource Tiles. Spend an Activate Action, then add the Tile's printed resources to the Warehouse, up to its limit.

Linked Production

The first time each round you activate a Resource Tile, check it and every **immediately adjacent** copy from the same Tile stack. If none of them has produced this round, the chosen Tile and all its immediately adjacent, non-Overstrained copies produce for that one Activate Action, each using its current side.

Linked Production never continues outward through a chain: only copies touching the chosen Tile join in. Mark every Tile that produced as having taken part this round. If the chosen Tile or an adjacent copy has already taken part, only the chosen Tile produces. A separate group of copies elsewhere may still use Linked Production. Everything refreshes at the start of the next round.



Three upgraded Mine Shafts on the Mountains, each producing 3 Stone and 2 Metal. The Sentinel activates the middle one (1): it and both copies touching it produce, 9 Stone and 6 Metal for one Action. Activating any of them again this round produces only from the Tile chosen: 3 Stone and 2 Metal.

EXAMPLE Had the Sentinel activated the left Mine Shaft instead, only it and the middle one would touch, giving 6 Stone and 4 Metal. The right one does not touch the left one and has not taken part, but its neighbour the middle one has, so it could later produce only alone that round.

The Warehouse

All resources are shared and kept on the Logistics board: pieces above the stitch are in the Warehouse, spares sit below. Each resource holds at most 15 unless an effect changes the limit. Any gain beyond the limit is lost. Resources never go below zero.

Reading a Tile



Cottage: the basic side



Fine Cottage: the upgraded side

1. **Category.** The symbol beside the name: Resource, Housing, Travel, Merchant, Crafting, Social or Wellbeing.
2. **Name.**
3. **Placement symbol.** A terrain symbol means place on that terrain; a symbol in a hexagon means place beside that terrain or Tile category. Here: beside a Housing Tile.
4. **Printed scores.** Population on the left, Renown on the right.
5. **Place.** The cost to place the basic side.
6. **Upgrade.** The cost to flip it to the upgraded side.
7. **Effect.** Activate needs an Activate Action. Passive works by itself, at the printed timing.
8. **Upgraded side.** A silver frame and the name of the basic side it came from.



Wood · Stone · Metal · Food · Herbs · Goods · Population · Renown

Read a number beside a symbol as that amount. Two costs separated by "or" mean pay either one. Once per round and once per Season refresh when the next round or Season starts. Special Tiles have a coloured margin and a numbered back. Golden Tiles have a gold frame and print their placement rule in the effect box.

Terrain, placement and adjacency

The Vale has seven terrains: Grasslands, Woodland, Arable Land, Mountains, Heaths, Ruins and River/Water. Read each placement rule exactly: the Mine Tunnel goes on Mountains, the Farmstead on Arable Land, the Salvage Camp on Ruins and the Bridge on River/Water. A Tile with no placement symbol may go on any land hex.


Woodland


Mountains


Heaths


Arable Land

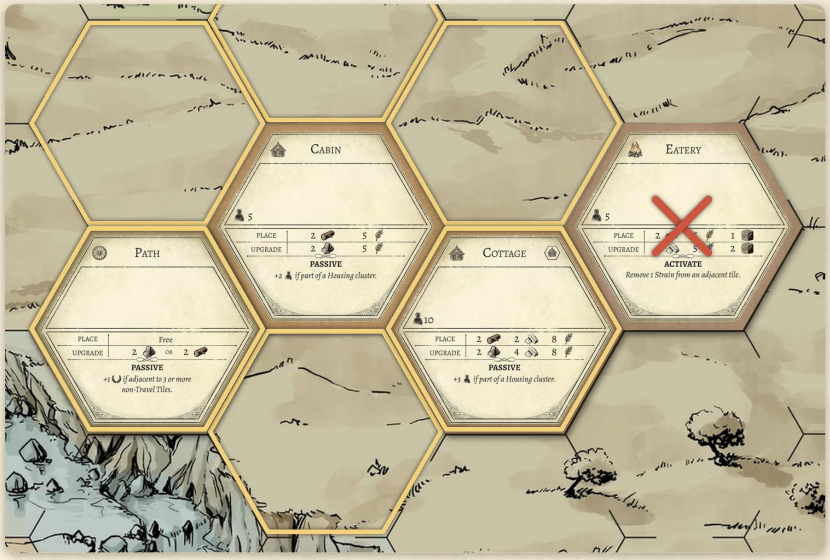

Ruins


River/Water


Grasslands

Adjacency

Tiles are adjacent when their hexes share a side. Requirements such as beside Housing, beside Travel and beside River/Water all use this rule.



The six hexes ringed in gold are adjacent to the Cabin. The Path and the Cottage are adjacent to it; the Eatery is not, though it touches the Cottage.

SHELTER IN THE RUINS When you place or upgrade a Tile whose whole footprint lies on Ruins, ignore all Stone in that cost. If any part of it lies outside the Ruins, pay the full cost.

Workshops and Market Stalls



Workshops and The Makers Conclave are Passive. Once per round, **Workshops** takes 1 resource off the cost to upgrade an adjacent Core Tile. **The Makers Conclave** instead takes up to 2 off the cost to upgrade any reachable Core Tile.



Market Stalls and The Seldes are Passive. Once per round while paying a cost, **Market Stalls** lets you spend 1 Goods as 1 resource of any type. **The Seldes** lets you spend 1 Goods as up to 2 resources of one type. Neither replaces Goods printed in the cost.

Reach, rivers and Bridges

Reachability

A Tile or empty hex is reachable when you can reach it from your meeple through the shared settlement network, or when a card, Tile or Steward rule says it is reachable. The network is every placed, non-Overstrained Tile joined side to side. Every Steward uses the same network, and an empty hex is reachable when it is next to a Tile you can reach.

Rivers and Bridges

River/Water is a barrier. Tiles on opposite banks do not connect, and you cannot reach across, unless a Bridge or another rule allows the crossing.



Without a Bridge the Cabin and the Salvage Camp are on opposite banks and do not connect.



A Bridge on the river joins the two banks into one network.

> *One roof became three. A path reached the workshop, another reached the river, and neighbours carried tools between them. Nobody planned the whole shape alone; the settlement grew wherever one piece of work made the next possible.*

STEWARD MEEPLES AND REACH After your first placement, your meeple moves whenever you Place, Upgrade or Activate. Your next reach starts from the Tile it is on. Overstrained Tiles do not join the network, so a settlement split by one may leave some Tiles out of reach.

Unlocking and placing Special Tiles

Completing an Arrival unlocks the Special Tile whose back number matches its reward. Unlocking does not place it. Later, any player may place it with a normal Place Action for no resources, following its printed placement rule.



Blade to Herb unlocks Special Tile 23



The back numbered 23, and its front: The Root Weavers Respite



Placed later on a reachable Heaths hex.

Special Tiles on their terrain

These Special Tiles go on the listed terrain. They need no adjacent Resource Tile. Their effects still apply exactly as written, and any other printed requirement still uses side-sharing adjacency.

PLACE ON	SPECIAL TILES
Heaths	13 Shrine of Ancients, 23 The Root Weavers Respite
Mountains	15 Shrine of Depths, 19 The Iron Roots Respite
Woodland	16 Shrine of Renewal, 21 The Reavers' Respite
Arable Land	14 Shrine of Bounty, 24 The Tamers' Respite
Ruins	12 Shrine of Ancestors, 20 The Lorekeepers' Respite

Special Tile numbers

1	Adventurers' Guild	10	Lantern Roadhouse	20	The Lorekeepers' Respite
2	Alchemist's Workshop	11	Reliquary	21	The Reavers' Respite
3	Alms House	12	Shrine of Ancestors	22	The Resting Hall
4	Atelier Workshop	13	Shrine of Ancients	23	The Root Weavers Respite
5	Brewery of Legends	14	Shrine of Bounty	24	The Tamers' Respite
6	Docks	15	Shrine of Depths	25	The Waystation
7	Hearth Garden	16	Shrine of Renewal	26	Theatre
8	House of Learning	17 and 18	Stables		
9	Labourers' Yard	19	The Iron Roots Respite		

Remnants of the Cavalry unlocks Stables (17 and 18): two separate hexes, placed by its printed rule.

Encounter Cards at a glance

Read every Encounter from top to bottom. The title and the italic story text set the scene; the rules are in the sections below them. A specific card rule overrides a general rule only for the situation it names.



Boon

Use the row for the current Season. The italic line under it says whether the card is used at once, stays face up, has limited uses or ends with the Season.



Burden

Apply the current row when it is revealed and leave the card active. Its italic line gives the Action and payment that resolve and discard it.



Arrival

Put a bronze timer in each of the three circles. Meet its Requirements with an Interact Action to unlock the Special Tile named in its Reward.



Golden Boon

No Season rows and no timers. Resolve it free when revealed; it does not count towards the cards revealed each round.

CURRENT SEASON Use row I in Foundations (Rounds 1 to 4), II in Growth (Rounds 5 to 8) and III in Maturity (Rounds 9 to 12).

The story text is narrative only. The italic line inside a Boon or Burden row is a rule, and so is the italic line at the foot of a Golden Boon.

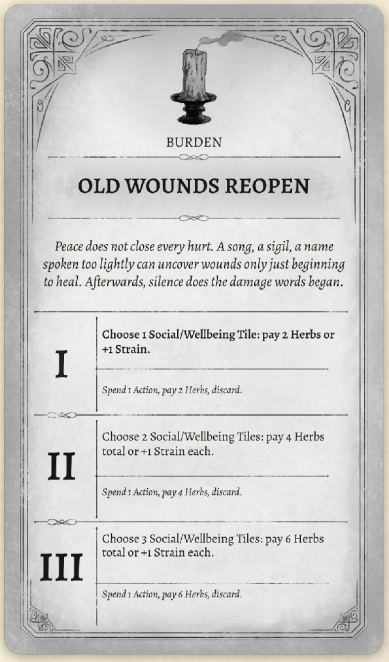
Boons and Burdens



Boons: help for the settlement

Read the current Season row and resolve it at once, unless its italic line says to keep the card face up. A kept Boon stays in play until it is used or its time runs out; then discard it. Using a face-up Boon costs no Action unless its text says so. Only one Boon may change a single Action unless a rule says otherwise.

For example, *A Little Time* adds 1 timer to an active Arrival in Season I, up to 3. Its later rows add up to 2 or 3 timers. It is kept until used or until the Season ends.



Burdens: pressure that stays

When a Burden is revealed, apply its current row and leave it face up as an active Burden. At the start of Seasons II and III, apply every unresolved Burden again using its new row.

Resolve a Burden by carrying out its printed resolution, usually with an Interact Action, or with an effect that resolves it. *Old Wounds Reopen* in Season I asks you to choose 1 Social or Wellbeing Tile, then pay 2 Herbs or take 1 Strain there. To discard it, spend 1 Action and pay 2 Herbs.

When a Burden offers payment or Strain, choose before drawing a Target Card, and draw only for the Strain. Resolving a Burden stops it from applying again; Strain it has already placed stays.

ACTIVE BURDENS SCORE AGAINST YOU Each Burden still active at the end of the game costs 10 points.

Arrivals



Arrivals are timed goals that unlock Special Tiles. When one is revealed, put it in play with a bronze timer in each of its 3 circles.

Quiet Quest asks for 4 Goods and 2 Herbs and unlocks Special Tile 1, the Adventurers' Guild.

To complete an Arrival, meet its Requirements and spend 1 Interact Action before its last timer is removed. Remove the timers, discard the card and set the unlocked Special Tile on the Tiles board.



More time. An activated Inn adds 1 timer to an active Arrival.



The Dawn Break Inn adds up to 2. An Arrival never holds more than 3 timers.

Arrival timing

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS
End of each round	Remove 1 timer from every active Arrival.
Its last timer is removed	The Arrival fails. Discard it and record one failed Arrival. Then make every placed Tile with fewer than 3 Strain eligible and draw a Target Card to choose one of them for 1 Strain. If there is no such Tile, place no Strain.
Still active after Round 12	It stays active. It does not fail, place Strain or cost points.

SEVERAL ARRIVALS FAIL TOGETHER Resolve each failure on its own. For each one, work out the eligible Tiles again and draw a fresh Target Card, returning it to the bottom of the deck before the next.

An easy way to count failures at the end: keep failed Arrivals face down in the discard well, apart from the other cards.

Strain and Supported

Strain

Strain is shown with black wooden tokens on the Tile. A Tile holds at most 3 Strain. At 1 or 2 Strain it works normally unless a rule says otherwise. If an effect would add Strain to a Tile already at 3, add nothing.

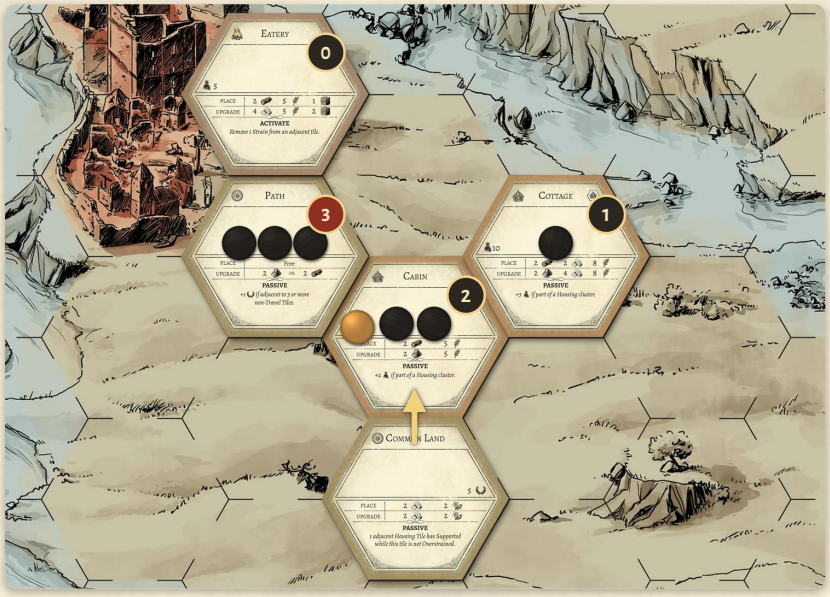
PARTIAL RESOLUTION If the full amount or number of targets is not available, place as much Strain as possible on as many eligible Tiles as possible. "If none" means no legal target exists; it never lets you choose zero while a legal target remains.

Supported

A bronze token on a Tile shows Supported. Supported stops 1 Strain before you check whether the Tile becomes Overstrained. A Tile either has Supported or does not: it never stacks.

Passive Supported lasts while its source's condition holds and stops the first Strain on that Tile each round. Common Land gives it to 1 adjacent Housing Tile; The Pleasance to up to 3. Choose them when the effect starts and keep them until the eligible Tiles change or the source becomes Overstrained. You cannot move it in answer to incoming Strain.

Single-use Supported, from placement, activation or another effect, stops 1 Strain and is then removed.



The Eatery has no Strain, the Cottage 1 and the Cabin 2. The Common Land gives the Cabin passive Supported (the bronze token), so the next Strain that reaches it this round is stopped. The Path holds 3 Strain and is Overstrained.

The Golden Garden and every other prevention apply at the same step as Supported. Prevented Strain is not placed, moved elsewhere or able to start a spread.

Overstrained Tiles and chains

A Tile becomes Overstrained when it goes from fewer than 3 Strain to 3. Leave it on the map. It cannot be activated or upgraded, gives no passive effects, does not join the network, scores no Population or Renown and meets no positive requirement. As soon as it drops below 3 it works again. Reaching 3 again later is a new Overstrain.

Resolving a chain

12.1 Finish the original effect, including every printed Strain and Strain Cascade.

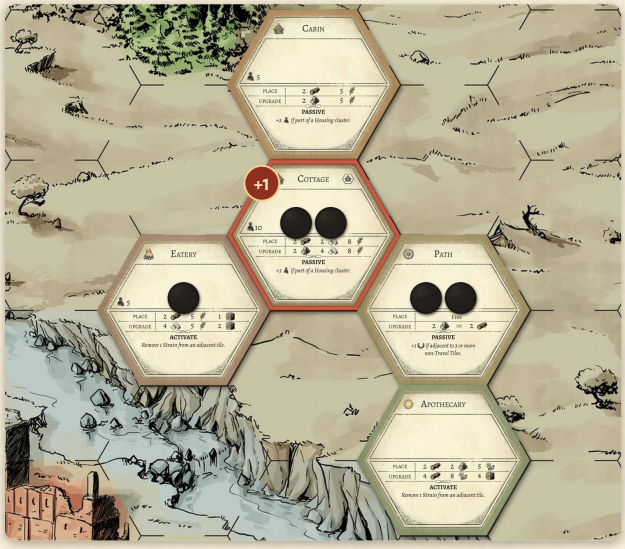
12.2 Find every Tile that went from fewer than 3 Strain to 3.

12.3 If there are several, choose the order in which they spread.

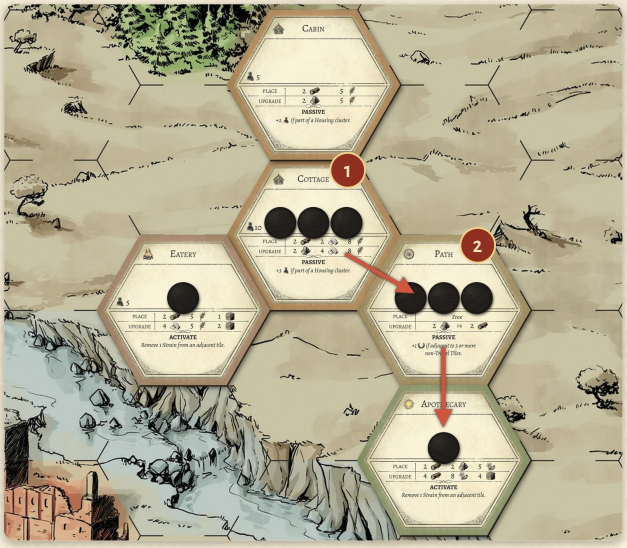
12.4 For each spread, draw a fresh Target Card. The eligible Tiles are the placed Tiles adjacent to the spreading Tile with fewer than 3 Strain.

12.5 Put 1 Strain on the chosen Tile, after Supported and any other prevention.

12.6 If that Tile becomes Overstrained, it spreads too. Carry on until no new spread remains.



Before: the Cottage and the Path beside it both hold 2 Strain. An effect adds 1 Strain to the Cottage.



After: the Cottage reaches 3. Its spread draws a Target Card, which picks the Path (1). The Path reaches 3 and spreads in the same chain; its card picks the Apothecary (2).

A Tile already at 3 does not spread just because another effect targets it. A printed Strain Cascade belongs to the effect that caused it: resolve every printed placement and Cascade before starting any chain they create. There is no automatic spread at the end of a Season.

Choosing where Strain lands



When an effect adds Strain, it says which Tiles are **eligible**. A Target Card then chooses among them, so nobody has to. It never adds a Tile the effect did not make eligible.

1. Start with only the Tiles the effect made eligible. Apply any printed fallback first.
2. Draw the top card for each separate target, even if only 1 Tile is eligible. Several Strain on the same Tile use one card.
3. Work down the four rows: Tile class, Tile side, Adjacency, then Current Strain.
4. At each row, keep the Tiles that match. **If none match, skip that row** and keep them all. Any changes nothing. Never bring back a Tile already ruled out.
5. If more than one Tile is left, take the one the arrow points to: the tied Tile furthest in that direction on the map.
6. Return the card face down to the bottom of the deck. Then apply Supported and other prevention. Prevented Strain is not moved elsewhere.

Tile class
Core, Special or Golden, or Any

Tile side
Basic, Upgraded, Either or Any

Adjacency
3 or more neighbours, 0 to 2 neighbours, or Any

Current Strain
Already strained, Unstrained or Any



Open cards

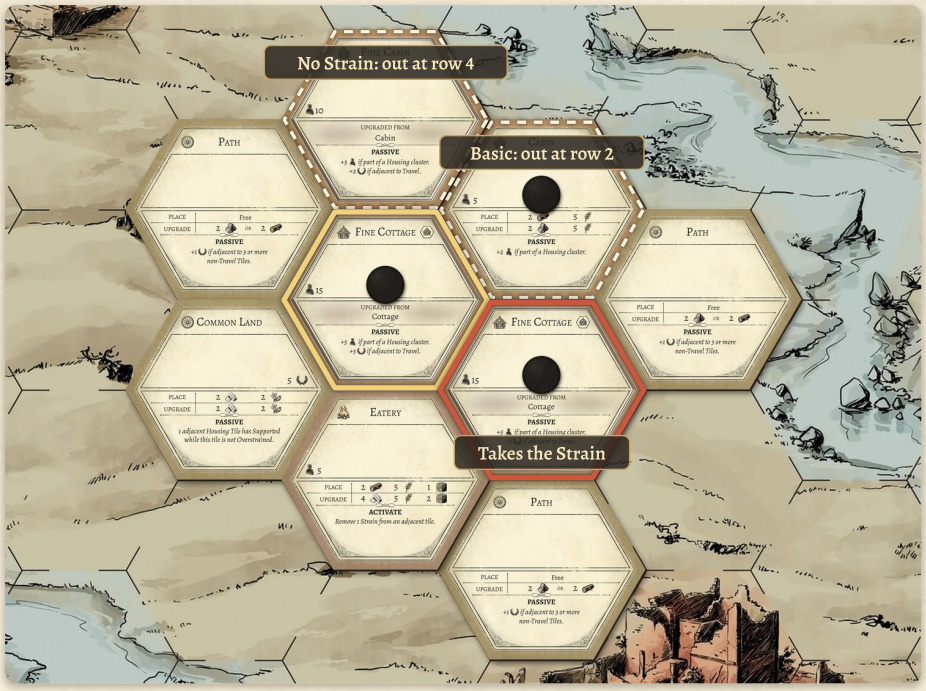
Cards 25 to 30 say Any on every row. Keep the eligible Tiles, then the players choose any one of them. No arrow is used.

Tie directions

The arrows follow the map's flat-top hexes: N, NE, SE, S, SW and NW, with north at the top of the map board. Each direction is on 4 cards. Hold the card the same way up as the board. If two Tiles are exactly level in that direction, take the one nearer the top of the map, then the one further left.

A Target Card at work

A Burden places 1 Strain on a Housing Tile. The four Housing Tiles are eligible. The players draw Target Card 05.





ROW	CARD 05 SAYS	TILES LEFT
Tile class	Core	All four are Core Tiles: all four stay.
Tile side	Upgraded	The Cabin is basic, so it goes. The Fine Cabin and both Fine Cottages stay.
Adjacency	3 or more neighbours	All three have at least 3 neighbouring Tiles: all stay.
Current Strain	Already strained	The Fine Cabin has no Strain, so it goes. Both Fine Cottages stay.
If still tied	Arrow to SE	The Fine Cottage further to the south-east, ringed in red, takes the Strain.

The card goes face down to the bottom of the deck. Had that Fine Cottage been Supported, the Strain would have been stopped there and not moved to another Tile.

When effects meet

When several rules seem to happen at once, use this order. Always finish every mandatory effect before moving to the next step.

In a round

1 Reveal

Reveal until the standard cards revealed equal the player count. Golden Boons do not count, so keep revealing.

2 Resolve

Apply each revealed card's current Season row and finish every payment, choice and Strain it creates.

3 Play

Choose the order. Each player takes one turn of up to 4 Actions. Free effects can be used during your turn.

4 End

Arrivals lose a timer and failures are resolved one by one. Short effects end, round effects refresh, the Round marker moves on.

When an effect would add Strain

Eligible The effect says which Tiles can take it

▸

Target Card Draw one to choose among them

▸

Prevent Supported or another prevention may stop it

▸

Apply Put the Strain on the Tile

▸

Chain Only once the whole effect is done: Tiles that reached 3 spread

Inside one effect

Finish everything the card or Tile prints first, including every Strain placement and Strain Cascade. Only then start Overstrain chains, one spread at a time, in the order the players choose.

When an effect gives a choice between paying and taking Strain, choose first. Draw a Target Card only if you take the Strain.

Between Seasons

After Rounds 4 and 8: Arrival failures, then Boons that end with the Season, Neighbourly Support, Burdens applied again with the new row, Steward Powers refreshed, and seeding last (page 27).

After Round 12, finish every pending effect, then score (page 28).

WHEN RULES CONFLICT Text on a specific card or Tile overrides a general rule, but only for the situation it names.

The six Stewards

Each Steward has a Starting Terrain, a Power used once per Season and an Objective worth +15 Renown at final scoring. A Power costs no Action unless it says so, needs no Tile, and refreshes at the start of each Season. Your Steward Guide has the full wording.



Vanguard I

Woodland

Power. Once per Season, when you place a Travel Tile, you may place it without spending an Action. Pay its cost and follow all placement rules. If it is placed adjacent to another Travel Tile or placed on a River/Water hex, it gains Supported.

Objective. At final scoring, gain +15 Renown if the settlement has non-Overstrained placed tiles on both sides of the river connected by a Bridge.



Knight II

Arable Land

Power. Once per Season, when you place a Housing Tile, you may place it without spending an Action. Pay its cost and follow all placement rules. If it is placed adjacent to another Housing Tile, it gains Supported.

Objective. At final scoring, gain +15 Renown if the settlement contains a Housing cluster of 3 or more non-Overstrained Housing Tiles.



Sentinel III

Mountains

Power. Once per Season, when you upgrade a Core Tile, you may upgrade it without spending an Action. Pay its cost and follow all upgrade rules. If it is adjacent to another upgraded Core Tile after upgrading, it gains Supported.

Objective. At final scoring, gain +15 Renown if the settlement contains 5 or more upgraded non-Overstrained Core Tiles.



Ranger IV

Heaths

Power. Once per Season, choose any legal empty hex or any placed non-Overstrained tile, connected or disconnected. Until the end of your turn, you may treat that hex or tile as reachable for your tile actions. If you place a tile there, pay its cost and follow all terrain, River/Water, and printed placement requirements.

Objective. At final scoring, gain +15 Renown if the settlement contains non-Overstrained placed tiles on at least 3 terrain types other than Grasslands and River/Water.



Warden V

Ruins

Power. Once per Season, when a Burden is revealed, you may prevent that Burden's revealed effect from triggering. The Burden still becomes active. Then either remove 1 Strain from any tile or place Supported on one tile.

Objective. At final scoring, gain +15 Renown if there are fewer active Burdens than the player count.



Quartermaster VI

Any terrain but Grasslands and River/Water

Power. Once per Season, exchange up to 5 resources in the Warehouse for the same number of resources of any type. Then add 1 timer token to an active Arrival with fewer than 3 timer tokens on it.

Objective. At final scoring, gain +15 Renown if the Warehouse contains 5 or more resources in at least 3 different resource types.

Only non-Overstrained Tiles count towards Objectives unless a rule says otherwise.

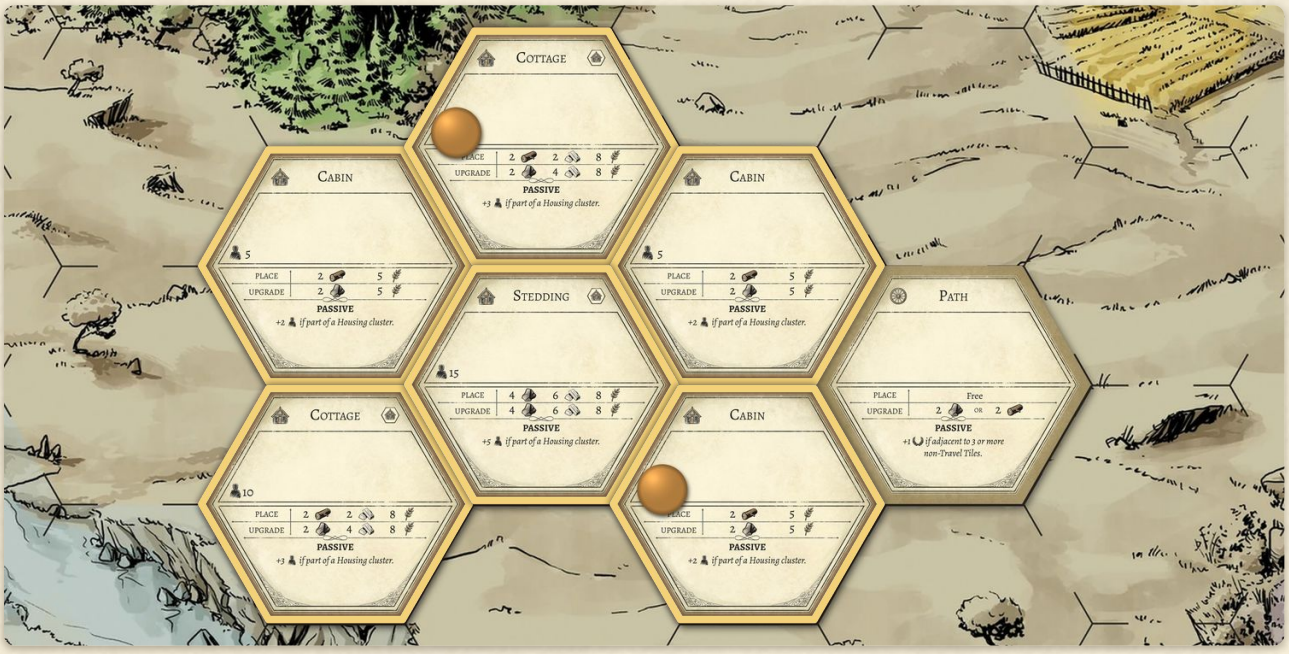
End of a Season

After Rounds 4 and 8, work through these steps in order before the next Season begins.

STEP	AFTER ROUNDS 4 AND 8
1	Finish every Arrival that ran out of timers.
2	Discard unused face-up Boons whose time ends with the Season.
3	Neighbourly Support (below).
4	Apply every unresolved Burden again, using the new Season row.
5	Refresh every Steward Power.
6	Seed the Encounter deck for the next Season (page 8).

Neighbourly Support

Each Housing cluster gains 1 single-use Supported for every complete group of 3 non-Overstrained Housing Tiles in it. Put each one on a different eligible Housing Tile in that cluster. Ignore Overstrained Tiles when tracing a cluster and counting its size.



A cluster of six Housing Tiles: two complete groups of 3, so it gains 2 Supported, placed on two different Tiles.

NO AUTOMATIC SPREAD Nothing spreads at the end of a Season. A chain starts only when a Tile newly reaches 3 Strain.

Final scoring

After Round 12 and every pending effect, work out one shared final score. There is no pass mark and no individual winner.

STEP	SCORE
1. Population	Population printed on, and given to, non-Overstrained Tiles.
2. Renown	Renown printed on, and given to, non-Overstrained Tiles, and from effects.
3. Steward Objectives	+15 for each Steward Objective met.
4. Quest Card	+20 if either half of the Quest Card is complete. Completing both gives no more.
5. Golden Tiles	+5 for each placed, non-Overstrained Golden Tile whose condition is met.
6. Active Burdens	–10 for each.
7. Failed Arrivals	–10 for each Arrival that ran out during play.
8. Strain	–10 for every Strain token on the map.

FINAL SCORE Add Population and every Renown bonus, then take away every penalty. Record the score, then file the Quest Card (page 29).

Scoring example

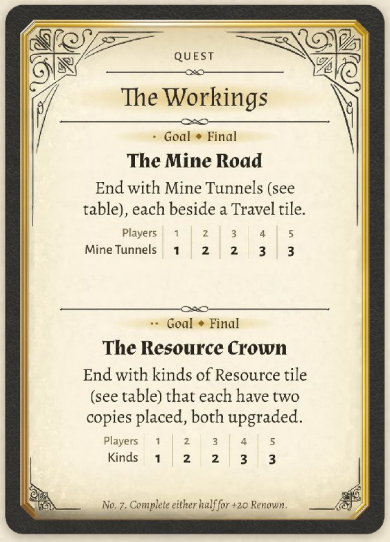
Population from Tiles	**80**
Renown from Tiles and effects	**25**
Two Steward Objectives met	**+30**
Quest Card complete	**+20**
One Golden Tile condition met	**+5**
Before penalties	**160**
One active Burden	**–10**
Two failed Arrivals	**–20**
Three Strain on the map	**–30**

SHARED FINAL SCORE

100

Unlocked Special Tiles that were never placed do not score. Overstrained Tiles neither score nor meet positive Objectives unless a rule says so.

Quest Cards



One Quest Card is in play each game, whatever the player count. Draw the top card of the Quest deck at setup.

Both halves are live. The top half (one pip) is easier; the bottom half (two pips) is harder. Complete either half and the card scores **+20 Renown**, once. Completing both gives no more.

Each half shows a target for every player count: read the column for yours.

Goal, Moment
Complete the moment it happens, even if the board changes later.

Goal, Final
Checked at final scoring.

Vow, All game
A rule that must hold all game. If it is ever broken, that half fails. Its "End with" target is checked at final scoring.

Quest Cards look only at the map: tile shapes and placements, never the score. The card on page 6, item 8, is Quest Card 7, The Workings.

The Steward's Ledger

The Steward's Ledger is the pile of completed Quest Cards your group keeps in the box. After final scoring:

1. If the Quest Card is complete, add it to the Ledger.
2. If not, put it at the bottom of the Quest deck, so it does not come straight back.
3. Once every card is in the Ledger, the completed cards come round again, in the order they were completed.

CARDS IN THE LEDGER	3	6	9	12	15
Golden Tile	The Golden Charter	The Golden Hearth	The Golden River Gate	The Golden Cairn	The Golden Garden
Golden Boon	The Golden Bell	The Golden Scroll	The Golden Vial	The Golden-Eyed Traveller	The Golden Signet Ring

Each milestone unlocks one Golden pair for good. Unlocked pairs stay available in every later game.

Golden content

Golden content is optional advanced material unlocked through the Steward's Ledger. It is not for a first game.

Golden setup

18.1 After the standard hands are dealt, choose up to 1 unlocked Golden Tile and up to 1 unlocked Golden Boon.

18.2 Place the Golden Tile on an eligible empty hex, following its printed rule. This costs no Actions and no resources.

18.3 Shuffle the Golden Boon into the Encounter deck. It never enters a hand and is never seeded.

18.4 When it is revealed, resolve it free. It does not count towards the standard reveal, so keep revealing.

Golden Tile scoring

At final scoring, each placed, non-Overstrained Golden Tile scores +5 Renown if its condition is met.



The Golden Charter

Place on any empty non-River hex.
+5 Renown: Adjacent to at least 4 different Tile categories.



The Golden River Gate

Place on a non-River hex adjacent to River/Water.
+5 Renown: Non-Overstrained Tiles on both sides of the river, connected by a Bridge or Stone Bridge.



The Golden Garden

Place on Grasslands, Woodland, or Ruins.
+5 Renown: The game ends with no Overstrained Tiles.



The Golden Hearth

Place on Grasslands, Woodland, or Arable Land. Not adjacent to River/Water.
+5 Renown: Surrounded by 6 placed, non-Overstrained Tiles.



The Golden Cairn

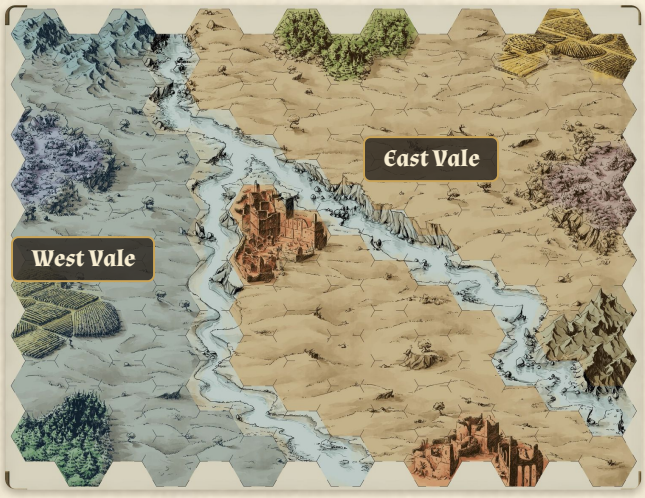
Place on Mountains, Heaths, Woodland, Arable Land, or Ruins. Not Grasslands or River/Water.
+5 Renown: Non-Overstrained Tiles on at least 4 terrains other than River/Water.

Golden Boons

Golden Boons never enter hands or seeding. When one is revealed, resolve it free, do not count it towards the standard reveal, and keep revealing. *The Golden Scroll*, for example, lets each player discard any standard Encounter Cards from their hand and draw the same number at random from the box; Golden Boons cannot be drawn, and if the box runs short, draw as many as you can. Then discard it.

Twin Settlements

An optional mode: two Vales grow on opposite banks of the river. Each team builds its own settlement with its own Warehouse, Tiles and Encounters, and the whole table shares one result. For 2 to 4 players; one player can also run both Vales.



The West Vale is the land west of the river's western channel, shaded blue.

The East Vale is all the other land, shaded gold, including both Ruins.

A team may cross the river to build, but its Tiles always belong to its own Vale.

Setup

- **Teams.** Split into two teams: 1 and 1, 2 and 2, or 1 and 2. In 1 and 2, the solo player chooses a Vale.
- **Stewards.** Choose different Stewards as normal, but leave out the Warden. A Quartermaster may not start on Ruins.
- **Meeples.** Each player puts their meeple on an empty hex of their Starting Terrain in their own Vale. Their first Action places a Tile there, as normal.
- **Tiles.** Split every stack of Core Tiles in half, one half for each Vale.
- **Warehouses.** Each Vale has its own: 15 of each resource for a one-player team, 10 of each for a two-player team.
- **Encounters.** Build one Encounter deck and set of hands for each team, using the normal setup for that team's size.
- **Leave out** the Docks, the Stables, the two Arrivals that unlock them, Golden content and the Quest Card. Replace each of those Arrivals with another unused Arrival.

Play

- Play 12 rounds as normal. Each round, both Vales reveal their own Encounters, then every player takes one turn of up to 4 Actions, in an order the whole table chooses.
- Teammates share everything in their Vale: the Warehouse, the Tile supply, the network, unlocked Special Tiles, Encounters, Strain and Supported.
- Turns, Actions, meeples, Steward Powers and Objectives stay individual.
- A team may only use, upgrade, activate or count its own Tiles, resources and Encounters.
- A team's first Tiles need not touch; once joined, they are one network.
- Read "each player" on a card as "each team", resolved once.
- Both teams draw from the one Target deck. Only the drawing team's Tiles are ever eligible.

NEVER JOIN THE VALES No Tile may be placed where it would connect the West Vale network to the East Vale network.

Score each Vale

Use the normal final scoring with only that team's Tiles, Steward Objectives, active Burdens, failed Arrivals and Strain.

One result

Record both scores together as the table's result. Nobody wins alone; the aim is two strong Vales.

Quick reference

The round

1 Reveal and resolve Encounters

2 Choose the order; each player takes one turn of up to 4 Actions

3 Remove Arrival timers, resolve failures, tidy up, move the Round marker

Placing Strain

Select
Find the eligible Tiles, then draw a Target Card

Prevent
Supported and other prevention first

Check
At 3 Strain the Tile is Overstrained

Chain
After the effect, each newly Overstrained Tile spreads 1 Strain

Season transition, after Rounds 4 and 8

1. Finish Arrival failures.
2. Discard Boons that end with the Season.
3. Neighbourly Support: 1 Supported per 3 Housing Tiles in a cluster.
4. Apply every Burden again with the new row.
5. Refresh every Steward Power.
6. Seed the Encounter deck.

Watch a Tile's Strain

1 or 2
It still works normally.

3
Overstrained: no effects, no connection, no score, and it spread 1 Strain when it got there.

Bronze
Supported: the next Strain is stopped.

Costs and limits

RULE	REMEMBER
Warehouse	At most 15 of each. Start with 15, 10, 5, 0 or 0 of each for 1 to 5 players. Never below zero.
Special Tile	Once unlocked: 1 Place Action, its placement rule, no resources.
0 Actions	Only the Action is free. Pay the resource cost unless the effect changes it.
Steward meeple	Place, Upgrade and Activate move it. Interact does not.
Arrival	Starts with 3 timers, never more. Remove 1 from each at the end of every round.
Target Card	Start from the eligible Tiles, work down the rows, then return the card face down to the bottom.
Quest Card	Either half complete: +20 Renown, once.

Add
Population and Renown on non-Overstrained Tiles, +15 each Steward Objective met, +20 Quest Card, +5 each Golden condition met

Take away 10
for each active Burden, each failed Arrival and each Strain on the map

Questions at the table

01 **Does "0 Actions" also waive the resources?**

No. Only the Action is free. Pay the normal cost unless the effect also changes it. Page 12.

02 **Is an unlocked Special Tile free to place?**

It costs no resources, but it still takes a Place Action, a reachable hex and its printed placement rule. Page 17.

03 **Does Linked Production run down a line of copies?**

No. Only copies touching the chosen Tile join in, and only the first time that group produces each round. Page 13.

04 **Does a Tile already at 3 Strain spread again when it is targeted?**

No. It spreads only when it goes from fewer than 3 to 3. If it is relieved and later reaches 3 again, it spreads again. Page 22.

05 **A Burden says pay or take Strain. When do we draw the Target Card?**

Choose first. Draw a Target Card only if you take the Strain. Page 19.

06 **Can an Arrival still be active after Round 12?**

Yes. It does not fail, place Strain or cost points. Page 20.

07 **Two Tiles are exactly level in the arrow's direction. Which one?**

The one nearer the top of the map; if still level, the one further left. Page 23.

08 **Does Interact move my meeple?**

No. Only Place, Upgrade and Activate move it. Page 12.

09 **The Warehouse is full and a Tile produces more. What happens?**

The extra is lost. The Warehouse holds at most 15 of each resource, and never goes below zero. Page 13.

10 **Can we complete both halves of the Quest Card for 40 Renown?**

No. Either half completes the card, for +20 Renown once. Page 29.

11 **Do Golden Boons count towards the cards revealed each round?**

No. Resolve one free and keep revealing until enough standard cards are out. Page 30.

12 **What happens to a failed Quest Card?**

It goes to the bottom of the Quest deck. A completed card goes into the Steward's Ledger. Page 29.

Glossary

Action	One of up to 4 things you do on your turn: Place, Upgrade, Activate or Interact.
Activated Effect	A Tile effect used by spending an Activate Action.
Active Burden	A revealed Burden that has not been resolved.
Adjacent	Sharing a hex side.
Arrival	A timed Encounter completed with an Interact Action to unlock its Special Tile.
Available Tile	A Core Tile still in the supply, or an unlocked Special Tile ready to place.
Boon	A helpful Encounter, used at once or kept face up for its printed time.
Burden	An Encounter that applies its current row and stays active until resolved.
Core Tile	A double-sided Tile with a basic side and an upgraded side.
Eligible	A Tile an effect says Strain may land on. A Target Card chooses only among eligible Tiles.
Failed Arrival	An Arrival whose last timer was removed during play.
Golden Tile	Optional advanced content unlocked through the Steward's Ledger and placed at setup.
Housing cluster	A group of non-Overstrained Housing Tiles joined side to side.
Linked Production	The first activation of a Resource Tile each round, with every adjacent copy from the same stack producing too. It does not chain outward.
Network	Every placed, non-Overstrained Tile joined side to side.
Overstrain chain	The spreads caused by newly Overstrained Tiles after the original effect.
Overstrained	A Tile at 3 Strain. It does nothing positive until it drops below 3.
Passive Effect	A Tile effect that works without an Action while its condition holds.
Pending effect	A mandatory choice, payment, placement, Strain, chain or other instruction already started but not finished.
Quest Card	This game's shared challenge. Complete either half for +20 Renown.
Reachable	A Tile or empty hex your meeple can reach through the network or by a specific rule.
River/Water	The map's water. It blocks connection unless a Bridge or another rule allows the crossing.

Glossary, continued

Round	Reveal Encounters, one turn per player, then the end of the round.
Season	Four rounds: Foundations (1 to 4), Growth (5 to 8) or Maturity (9 to 12).
Special Tile	A Tile unlocked by an Arrival and placed later with a Place Action for no resources.
Steward meeple	Your wooden piece on the map. Your reach starts from the Tile it stands on.
Steward's Ledger	Your group's pile of completed Quest Cards. It unlocks the Golden pairs.
Strain Cascade	Card-specific Strain placements resolved inside the original effect.
Supported	A bronze token that stops 1 Strain. Passive or single-use; never stacks.
Vow	A Quest Card half whose rule must hold all game.
Warehouse	The shared supply of resources, normally at most 15 of each.

Where to look

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THE QUIET VALE

A shared settlement. A changing Vale. One story built together.